Receipt OCR Got Me Stuck

Fix lighting, get data, automate expenses

The problem

> Photo taken under fluorescent light > glare obscured text > Claude returned empty result.

First attempt

> Prompted "extract table from image" > same empty output > assumed AI fault.

The simple fix

> Retake with phone flash > crop borders > run again > full line items appear.

Automate the flow

> CSV generated > import into Google Sheets > expense row created automatically.

Next steps

> Test crumpled receipts > add pre?processing script > reduce crashes.

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